Personality

by

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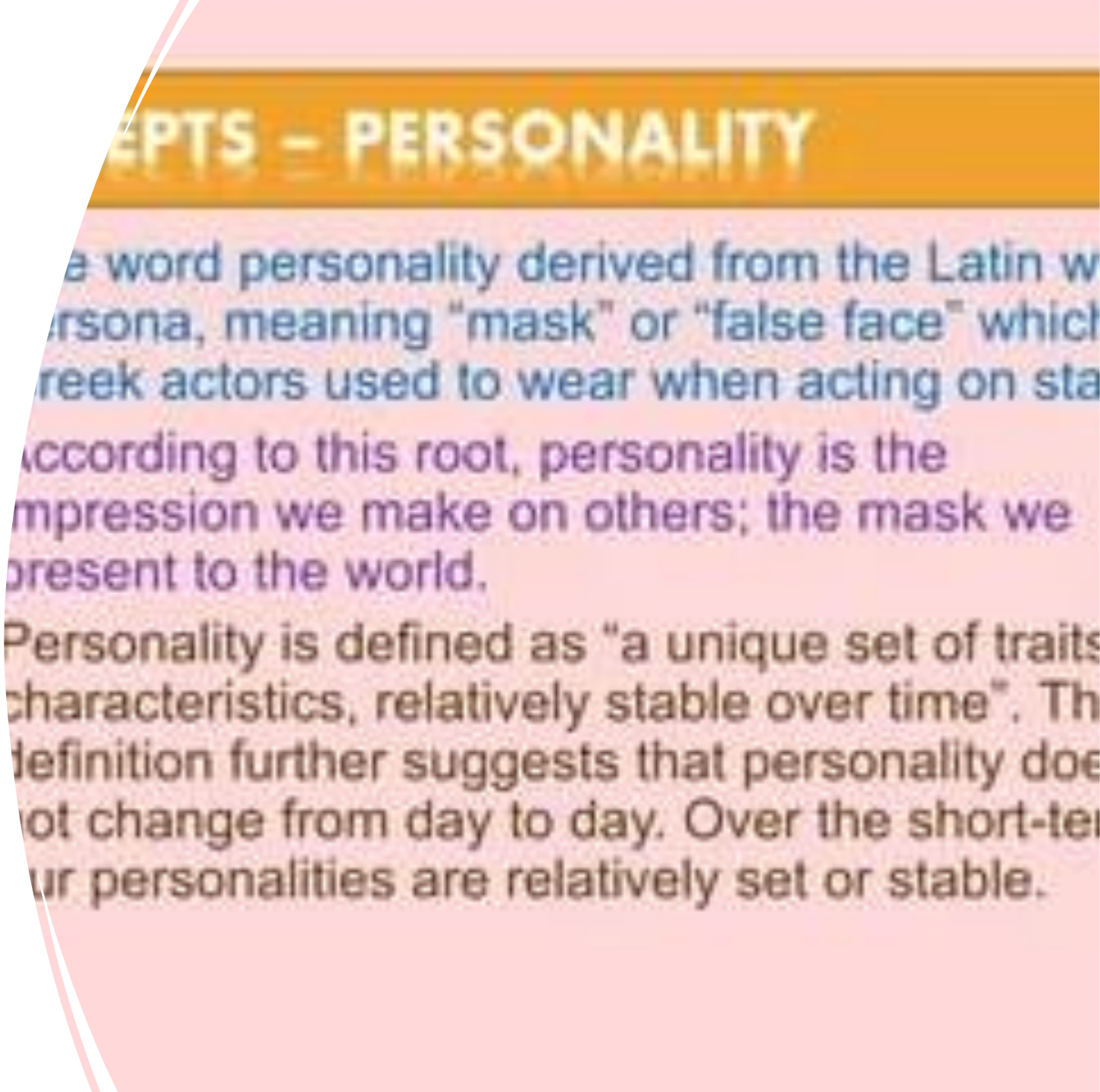
What do you mean by personality

- The mixture of how you think, behave, and feel that makes you different from other people.
- personality is the sum total of ways in which an individual reacts or interact with others in a given environment.



Definitions of Personality

According to Hilgard et at, “Personality may be understood as the characteristic patterns of behaviour and modes of thinking that determine a person's adjustment to the environment.”

In the opinion of Ruch, “Personality can be described as how he understands and views himself, and his pattern of inner and outer measurable traits”.

All port has defined personality as: “ the dynamic organisation within the individual of those psycho-physical systems that determine his unique adjustment to his environment.”

Thus, it reflects from above definitions that personality includes both internal and external aspects of a person

Difficult Workplace Personalities

Today's workgroups are made up of people from a variety of cultures, ethnicities, ages, and backgrounds. They also include different personalities. We spend countless hours at work and spending most of our time with our co-workers, colleagues than with our family and friends. Indeed for many of us, dealing with difficult personalities in the workplace can take a toll on one's health and well-being, as well as on the entire company or organization.

Read more: https://www.universalclass.com/articles/business/difficult-workplace-personalities-and-how-to-deal-with-them.htm

Personality

Personality is the combination of psychological traits we use to classify a person such as quite, loud, loyal, aggressive, sociable etc.

1. Biological factors
- heredity
- brain
- physical features

2. Social Factors
- home environment
- family members
- social groups

3. Cultural Factors
4. Situational factors

Characteristics of Personality

1) Individuals are different not only among themselves but also within themselves
2) Personality consists of feelings, thoughts, cognitions and visible behavior
3) When individuals act or react, they do so as total individuals and not as part of their selves
4) The visible behavior of an individual shows a consistency that spreads over different situations , with different people and at different times
5) Personality has a biological base, but is shaped by the environment
6) Behavior is also a characteristic of personality

Determinants of Personality

(i) Heredity

Heredity refers to those factors that were determined at conception.Thus, heredity refers to biological factors. Heredity is the transmission of the qualities from the parents to the children through a biological mechanism lying in the chromosomes of the germ cells

(ii) Environment

Culture establishes the norms, attitudes and values that are passed along from generation to generation. Home environment generated to a child and socialisation process also exerts important influence in shaping his/her personality

(iii) Situation

Situation, in fact, exerts an important pressure on the individual to behave in a particular manner

Personality traits by Cattell

Table 5.1: Sixteen Primary Traits of Personality

1.	Reserved	vs	Outgoing
2.	Less Intelligent	vs	More Intelligent
3.	Affected by Feeling	vs	Emotionally Stable
4.	Submissive	vs	Dominant
5.	Serious	vs	Happy-Go-Lucky
6.	Expedient	vs	Conscientious
7.	Timid	vs	Venturesome
8.	Tough-Minded	vs	Sensitive
9.	Trusting	vs	Suspicious
10.	Practical	vs	Imaginative
11.	Forthright	vs	Shrewd
12.	Self-assured	vs	Apprehensive
13.	Conservative	vs	Experimenting
14.	Group-Dependent	vs	Self-Sufficient
15.	Uncontrolled	vs	Controlled
16.	Relaxed	vs	Tense

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator

E — Extroverts
are energized by people, enjoy a variety of tasks, a quick pace, and are good at multitasking.

I — Introverts
often like working alone or in small groups, prefer a more deliberate pace, and like to focus on one task at a time.

S — Sensors
are realistic people who like to focus on the facts and details, and apply common sense and past experience to come up with practical solutions to problems.

N — Intuitives
prefer to focus on possibilities and the big picture, easily see patterns, value innovation, and seek creative solutions to problems.

T — Thinkers
tend to make decisions using logical analysis, objectively weigh pros and cons, and value honesty, consistency, and fairness.

F — Feelers
tend to be sensitive and cooperative, and decide based on their own personal values and how others will be affected by their actions.

J — Judgers
tend to be organized and prepared, like to make and stick to plans, and are comfortable following most rules.

P — Perceivers
prefer to keep their options open, like to be able to act spontaneously, and like to be flexible with making plans.

INTROVERTS	EXTROVERTS
• Prefer spending time in solitude.	• Have large social networks.
• Avoid being the center of attention.	• Enjoy being the center of attention.
• Think before they speak.	• Tend to think out loud.
• Value close 1:1 relationships.	• Loves being in large groups.
• Need time alone to recharge and reflect.	• Gain energy from being around other people.
• Prefer working in quiet, independent environments.	• Thrive in team-oriented and open work settings.
• Deeply focus and think about specific interests.	• Make quick decisions.

Sensing vs Intuition function highlights a person's tendency either to attend to sensory impressions or to instincts and gut feeling to understand physical reality.

VS

Signs of sensing personalities

- Attention to details
- Present focused
- Down to earth
- Prefers concrete information
- Prefers structure and routine
- Ability to recall events

Signs of intuitive personalities

- Has a distinct inner voice
- imaginative
- creative
- dreamers
- Future focused
- Prefers innovation

THINKERS	FEELERS
Logical	Passionate
Critical	Easily hurt
Confrontational to get a job done	Peacemakers
Needs Validation of Thoughts	Needs Validation of Feelings
Truth Seeking (What are the facts?)	Truth-Seeking (What emotions are being experienced?)
Task-oriented	Emotionally-oriented

Judging vs Perceiving refers to the functional preferences that determine how an individual approaches life; whether in an orderly and structured way.

Signs of Judging Personalities

1. Organized
2. Quick decision makers
3. Follows rules
4. Stubborn
5. Hardly change plans
6. Seeks closure
7. Prefers to control others

vs

Signs of Perceiving Personalities

1. Spontaneous
1. Easygoing and relaxed
3. Disregards rules
4. Open to new changes
5. Adaptable
6. Disorganized
7. Procrastinates a lot

There are 8 letters that are used in the assessment, and they make up sixteen possible Myers-Briggs Types:

- E – Extroversion indicates people who focus on the outer world of people and things. Indicates a tendency inwards towards your thoughts and ideas.
- I – Introversion represents people who focus on the inner world of ideas and impressions.
- S – Sensing defines people who process information through their five senses.
- N – Intuition defines people who process information through patterns and possibilities.
- T – Thinking people are objective and base their decisions on logic.
- F – Feeling people are subjective and tend to base their decisions on how options affects people.
- J – Judging indicates people who order their lives through planning and keeping schedules.
- P – Perceiving indicates people who prefer the flexible and spontaneous approach to life.

ISTJ	ISFJ	INFJ	INTJ
ISTP	ISFP	INFP	INTP
ESTP	ESFP	ENFP	ENTP
ESTJ	ESFJ	ENFJ	ENTJ

Types of Personality

- **Type A Personality:** Type A people are characterised by hard-working, highly achievement-oriented, impatient, have sense of time urgency, aggressive, with competitive drive, etc. Such people tend to be very productive and work very hard. In fact, they are workaholics. Being impatient and aggressive, such people are more prone to heart attack.

- **Type B Personalities:** Easy-going, sociable, free from urgency of time, laid-back
- and non-competitive are the characteristics of Type B personalities. Such people do
- better on tasks involving judgements, accuracy rather than speed and team work.

TYPE A PERSONALITY	TYPE B PERSONALITY
Self-driven & Highly Competitive -	- Less competitive & Focused on Enjoying Life
Ambitious & Goal Oriented -	- Easy-going, Relaxed & Highly Flexible
Impatient & Intolerant -	- Energetic, Outgoing, yet a Laid-back Attitude
Aggressive & Hostile -	- Imaginative & Creative
Controlling & Dominant -	- Lighthearted & Persuasive
High Risk of Heart Disease -	- High Levels Of Life Satisfaction
Entrepreneurial & Workaholic -	- Fun-loving, Easygoing & People-Oriented
Sense of urgency -	- Enthusiastic & Spontaneous
Fast-paced & Too Busy To Enjoy Life -	- Friendly & Inspiring
Motivated by Challenges -	- Self-confident & Reflective
Easily Stressed Out -	- Highly Patient & Less Prone to Stress

THEORIES OF PERSONALITY

- Trait Theory
  - Trait theory is based on the following three assumptions:
    - Traits are common to many individuals but vary in absolute amounts between the individuals
    - Traits are relatively stable. Their consistent occurrence influences the human behaviour.
    - One's trait can be inferred by measuring his/her behavioural indicators
  - Cattell first isolated 171 traits and, then, the same reduced to 16 traits, which he termed as source or primary traits
  - Thus, trait theory of personality attempts to understand how a set of personality variables exerts on one's behaviour

The Big-Five Model

- Trait Theory
  - In recent years, John has propounded a personality model called The Big 5 Model
  - In this model, he advocates that the following five basic personality variables/ dimensions underlie all other variables:
    - **Extraversion**: Who is sociable, talkative, and assertive
    - **Agreeableness:** One who is good-natured, co-operative, sharing, empathetic and trusting
    - **Conscientiousness**: A person who is responsible, dependable, persistent, planning and achievement oriented
    - **Emotional Stability (**Neuroticism): Someone characterised by calm, nervous, enthusiastic, depressed and insecure. Physical and emotional response to stress
    - **Openness to Experience:** A person who is imaginative, artistically sensitive and intellectual

Big-five model

- Extroversion is *Sociability*
- Agreeableness is kindness
- Conscientiousness is thoughtfulness
- Neuroticism is *sadness and emotional stability*
- openness is *creativity*

THE BIG FIVE PERSONALITY

PENNESS TO EXPERIENCE

Imagination, curiosity, the enjoyment of abstract thinking and ideas, and attunement towards personal emotions.

ONSCIENTIOUSNESS

Behaviours associated with: competence, order, dutifulness, attitude towards achievement, self-discipline and planning.

XTRAVERSION

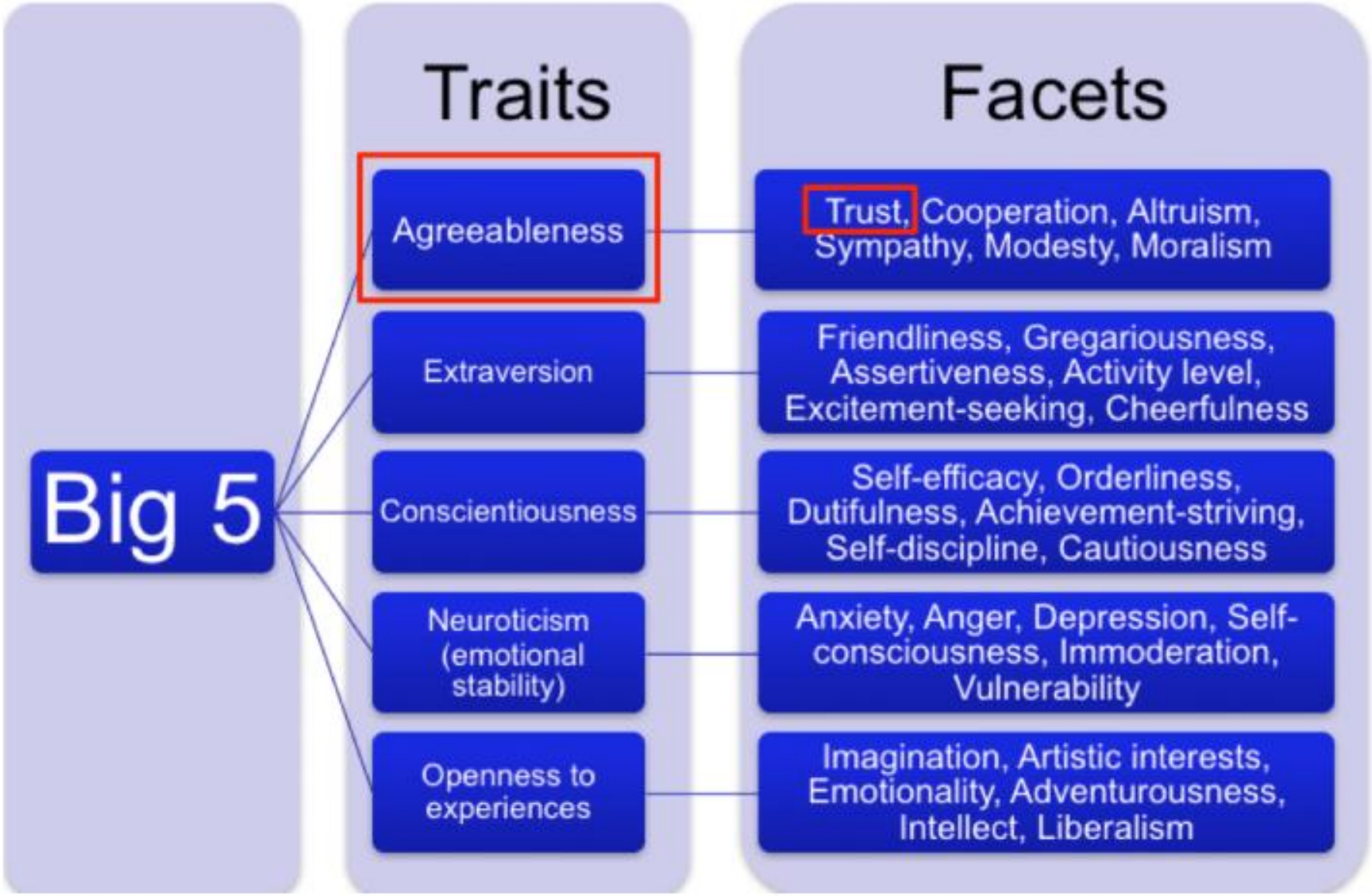
A measure of sociability and outgoingness. Associated with warmth, gregariousness, assertiveness, energy, excitement-seeking and positive emotions.

GREEABLENESS

Attitudes about the goodness and trustworthiness of others, and ability to emphasise with others.

EUROTICISM

Tendency for emotional instability, measured by the facets of anxiety, angry hostility, depression, self-consciousness, impulsivity and vulnerability.


Big 5
Traits
Facets
Agreeableness
Trust, Cooperation, Altruism, Sympathy, Modesty, Moralism
Extraversion
Friendliness, Gregariousness, Assertiveness, Activity level, Excitement-seeking, Cheerfulness
Conscientiousness
Self-efficacy, Orderliness, Dutifulness, Achievement-striving, Self-discipline, Cautiousness
Neuroticism (emotional stability)
Anxiety, Anger, Depression, Self-consciousness, Immoderation, Vulnerability
Openness to experiences
Imagination, Artistic interests, Emotionality, Adventurousness, Intellect, Liberalism

Psychoanalytical Theory

- The basic notion on which psychoanalytical theory is based on is that human behaviour is influenced more by unseen forces than conscious and rational thoughts
- Sigmund Fraud developed psychoanalytical theory based on his 40 years of writings and clinical practice
- This unconscious framework is composed of three elements—**id, ego** and **super ego**
- In total, it can be concluded that the **id seeks pleasure, the ego verifies reality and the super ego strives for perfection**

Theories

- Social Learning Theory
  - Learning can simply be defined as any change in one's behaviour that occurs as a result of experience
  - Learning occurs through two ways : (*i*) Reinforcement, and (*ii*) Observing Others
  - Learning by observing others is also called ‘**vicarious learning**’
  - The social learning theory emphasises on how an individual behaves or acts in a given situation
  - Admittedly, situation evokes an individual's behavioural pattern
  - At the same time, it is also true that an individual's behaviour also at times influences the situational conditions. Individual, by selectively attending to what is happening, can prevent certain conditions from impinging on him/her
  - Thus, the relationship between the situation and the individual is of reciprocal pattern

HOW PERSONALITY DEVELOPS?

- Erikson's Eight Life Stages
  - **Infancy:** The first year of life of a person is characterised by **trust vs mistrust**
  - **Early Childhood**: This stage spreads between two and three years of a child
  - **Play Age:** In the age of four and five years, the child seeks to discover what can be done
  - **School Age:** When the child joins school from ages 6 to 12 years, he/she learns knowledge and skills
  - **Adolescence:** The children during their teenage period try to gain a sense of identity for them in the society
  - **Young Adulthood:** The young during their twenties try to develop deep and permanent relationship with others to have a feeling of **intimacy**
  - **Adulthood:** The adults during forties and fifties of their ages face the situation of **generativity** or self-absorption
  - **Old (Sunset) Age:** The adult of **integrity** gains a sense of wisdom

Sheldon's Personality Development

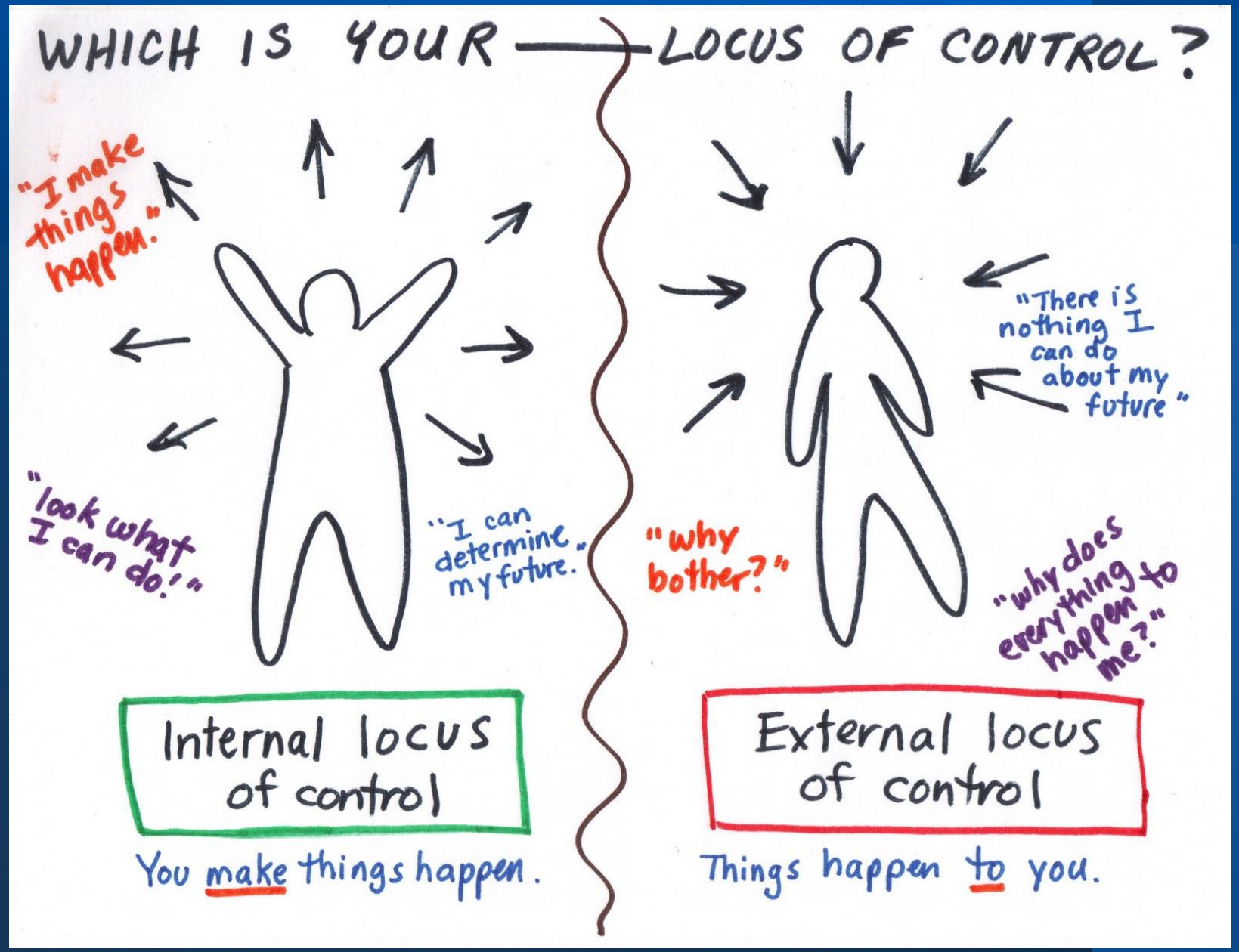
- Sheldon tried to explain personality development based on an individual's body build
- He labelled different body builds reflecting certain personality characteristics

Table 5.4: Body Builds vis-a-vis Personality Characteristics

Body Builds	Personality Characteristics
1. Endomorph (Fleshy)	Friendly, people oriented, seeks others when in trouble, slow to react, loves to eat.
2. Mesomorph (Athletic)	Seeks physical adventure, enjoys exercise, aggressive, risk taker, competition oriented.
3. Ectomorph (Thin)	Likes privacy, socially inhibited, quick to react and hypersensitive to pain.

HOW PERSONALITY INFLUENCES ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

- **Locus of Control**: Locus of control refers to one's belief that what happens is either within one's control or beyond one's control
- **Authoritarianism**: the degree to which a person believes that status and power differences are appropriate in the organization.
- **Dogmatism**: it refers to the degree of flexibility or rigidity of the person’s views.
- **Machiavellianism**: The personality characteristic of Machiavellianism (Mach) is named after Niccolo Machiavelli who wrote in the sixteenth century about how to gain and manipulate power. The end justifies the means.
- **Self-Esteem**: An individual's liking or disliking oneself is called self-esteem
- Self-Monitoring: Self-monitoring is a personality trait that has recently received increasing attention
- **Risk-Taking**: The propensity to assume or avoid risks affects a manager's behaviour in making decisions
- **Type A Personality**: In brief, type A people are impatient and aggressive to achieve more and more in less and less time


WHICH IS YOUR LOCUS OF CONTROL?
"I make things happen."
"look what I can do!"
"I can determine my future."
Internal locus of control
You make things happen.
"There is nothing I can do about my future"
"why bother?"
"why does everything to happen me?"
External locus of control
Things happen to you.

Authoritarianism

DOGMATISM

DEFINITION

Dogmatism is the unwavering belief in a set of principles or doctrines without considering or accepting alternative viewpoints or evidence. It denotes a rigid stance, often based on religious, philosophical, or ideological beliefs, that resists change or questioning. Such a mindset can inhibit open dialogue and critical thinking.

EXAMPLES

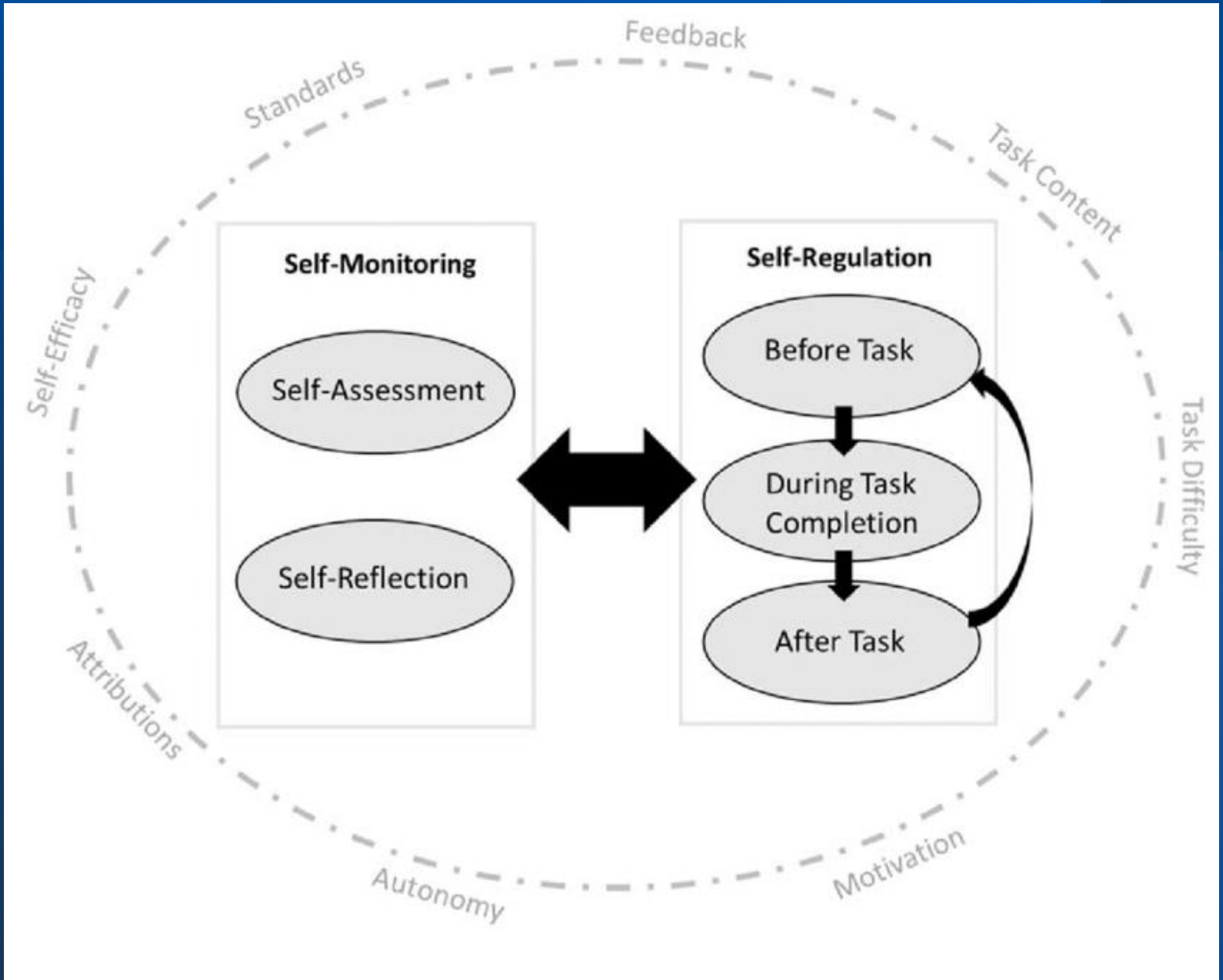
- **Creationism:** Despite extensive evidence supporting evolution, creationists assert otherwise, often due to dogmatic adherence to religious explanations.
- **Climate Change:** Despite overwhelming scientific evidence that humans are causing climate change, some deniers assert that this is not the case.

High Machiavellianism
Better to be feared than loved
The ends justify the means

Low Machiavellianism
Loyalty and relationships matter
Other people's opinions matter

What Is Self-Esteem?

Self-esteem describes your thoughts and feelings about yourself. Because self-esteem involves your thoughts and feelings about yourself and your level of confidence, it isn't stable or consistent. Instead, it depends heavily on the outer world of people, tasks, and external information used to compare, judge, and evaluate yourself.


Feedback
Standards
Task Content
Self-Efficacy
Task Difficulty
Attributions
Autonomy
Motivation
Self-Monitoring
Self-Assessment
Self-Reflection
Self-Regulation
Before Task
During Task Completion
After Task

Risk
Safe

Check the box next to which one fits you best in each section:

Extrovert		Introvert	
I have a lot of energy		I am laid back	
I prefer to be around people		I prefer to be alone	
I do things without stopping to think		I like to think before doing something	
I like to do many things at the same time		I need to focus on one thing at a time	
I like when people pay attention to me		I like to pay attention to other people	
Total:		Total:	

Sensors		iNtuitives	
I like clear and specific information		I like to be creative and come up with new ideas	
I like clear instructions/directions		I like to figure things out on my own	
I like facts, timelines, and details		I like to think outside the box/be creative	
I always use past experience to make decisions		I follow my instincts to make decisions	
I like to use data		I like more abstract ideas	
Total:		Total:	

Thinkers		Feelers	
I use facts to make decisions		I use feelings to make decisions	
I think about different parts of the problem		I think about how other people feel	
I use direct and honest language		I use vague and not direct language	
I make decisions using my head		I follow my heart to make decisions	
I like to debate and argue with others		I don't like to debate or argue with people	
Total:		Total:	

Judgers		Perceivers	
I like to make a "to do" list		I like to go with the flow	
I like to have a schedule/plan for the day		I do not like to have a schedule/plan	
I always study first, then play		I usually play first, then study	
I start and finish all projects		I start projects, but don't always finish	
I think it is important to be on time		I think being late is fine	
Total:		Total:	